Manager Conversation Handout

Managing Gen Z in India

A quick-reference guide for everyday leadership conversations

How to use this Handout?

This handout is designed for **in-the-moment use.**

Use it when:

- you're about to give feedback
- you're facing pushback
- a growth conversation is coming up
- emotions feel high
- discipline feels uncomfortable

You do **not** need to read the full playbook before using this.

Think of this as:

A conversation stabiliser, not a script book.

Write Notes

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Feedback Quick Guide

Before you speak, **check:**

□ Is this conversation private?
□ Am I addressing behaviour, not personality?
□ Do I know what "good" looks like next time?

Use the **SAFE** Structure:

S — Situation (specific)
A — Action (what happened)
F — Focus (impact on work)
E — Expectation (next step)

One-Line Feedback Script:

"In ___, I noticed ___. This impacts ___. Going forward, I expect ___."

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Handling Pushback (Resistence Decoder)

First, **Don't Assume** Attitude

Most pushback is about:

□ clarity
□ confidence
□ capacity

Ask One of These:

- "Help me understand what's making this difficult."
- "Is this about clarity, workload, or confidence?"
- "What support would help you deliver this well?"

If Emotions Rise:

"Let's pause and focus on what needs to happen next."

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Growth & Promotion Conversations

Remember:

Growth ≠ Promotion

Use This Framing:

“Let’s talk about skills and impact first, then roles.”

Saying “Not Yet” Safely:

“You’re not ready yet, and here’s what readiness looks like. Let’s review progress again in ___ months.”

Clarity is kinder than reassurance.

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Bunout & Boundary Check

Early Warning Signs:

□ withdrawal
□ irritability
□ silence
□ drop in quality

Safe Check-in Question:

“How manageable does your workload feel right now?”

Boundary Script:

“This can wait until working hours. Let’s pick it up tomorrow.”

When Unsure:

Escalation is support, not punishment.

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Discipine without Toxicity

Discipline = Course Correction

Use This Structure:

1. State the pattern
2. Explain the impact
3. Set the expectation
4. Define follow-up

Discipline Script:

“We’ve discussed this earlier, and it’s still happening. This needs to change, and here’s how we’ll track it.”

Always Follow Up

Consistency = fairness.

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Manager Self-Check (30 seconds)

Before any difficult conversation, ask yourself:

□ Am I reacting or responding?
□ Am I clear on the outcome I want?
□ Is my tone neutral and respectful?
□ Have I explained the ‘why’?

If yes → proceed.
If not → pause.

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Closing Note

This handout is designed to support **thoughtful, effective conversations,** not to prescribe a single “right” way to lead.

Every manager brings:

- their own style
- their own experience
- their own context

Use these scripts and principles as:

- **reference points,** not rigid lines
- **guidance,** not rules
- **support,** not replacement for judgment

Not every conversation needs a script.
Not every situation needs intervention.

What matters most is:

- clarity of intent
- respect for context
- consistency in behaviour

As trust grows within your team, conversations will become more natural and less structured.

This handout is meant to help **in moments where clarity, calm, and structure matter most.**